> **NOTE** Query DSL is like a Swiss Army knife when it comes to talking to Elasticsearch, and it is the preferred option. The Elasticsearch team developed this DSL specifically to work with the engine. Anything and everything we want to ask Elasticsearch can be retrieved using Query DSL.

Don't fret if you don't understand search queries and how they are coded. We work through several examples in this chapter and discuss them in detail in coming chapters.

8.4.2 Query vs. filter context

We need to examine another fundamental concept: the execution context. Internally, Elasticsearch uses an execution context when running searches. This execution context can be either a *filter* context or a *query* context. All queries issued to Elasticsearch are carried out in one of these contexts. We can't ask Elasticsearch to apply a certain type of context—our query lets Elasticsearch decide and apply the appropriate context. For example, if we are running a `match` query, it should be executed in a query context, whereas a `filter` query is executed in a filter context. Let's execute a couple of queries to understand the context in which the query is executed.

QUERY CONTEXT

We use a `match` query to search for documents by matching keywords with the field's values. The following listing is a simple `match` query that searches for "Godfather" in the `title` field.

Listing 8.3 Match query executed in a query context

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "query": {
    "match": {
      "title": "Godfather"
    }
  }
}
```

This code returns our two *Godfather* movies, as expected. However, if we look at the results closely, each movie has an associated relevancy score:

```
"hits" : [{
 ...
 "_score" : 2.879596
 "_source" : {
   "title" : "The Godfather"
   ...
 }
},
{
   ...
   "_score" : 2.261362
   "_source" : {
```